organized in the memory of former Prime Minister I.K. Gujral, said '… perhaps the massacre of the Sikhs that took place in November 1984 could have been avoided' had Rao acted on the advice of Gujral to call in the army at the earliest to control the situation. [5] It appears that Dr Singh may not have been aware that Rao had been rendered powerless by the 1 Akbar Road group by the time Gujral and others met him with the request to call the army to control the situation.

Obviously, with 10 Janpath in control of the Congress, senior Congress leaders continued to toe the party line on the issue for decades. That policy, as revealed by the statements made by senior party leaders over the years from time to time, can be summed up as 'oppose every move aimed at linking 1 Akbar Road with the anti-Sikh pogrom, launch counter-offensive by blaming others of similar crimes, continue denying any role of the Congress as long as possible'. The hope was that lies uttered repeatedly would gain currency as gospel truth and that, over a period of time, all would be forgotten or become outdated and irrelevant.

On 9 May 2019, head of the Indian Overseas Congress, Sam Pitroda, answering a question about the anti-Sikh pogrom by a television reporter at a meeting at Dharamsala, Himachal Pradesh, said in a nonchalant manner, '*Hua to hua'* (What happened, happened). [6] Though senior party leaders, including Rahul Gandhi, tried to control the damage and made Pitroda apologize for his remarks, Pitroda's inadvertent and unguarded remark had let the cat out of the bag.

The BJP perspective

As far as the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) was concerned, with the Akali Dal leaders forced to adopt a hard-line stance on issues of Sikh interest, and Indira Gandhi having hijacked the Hindu agenda, the BJP adopted an equally pro-Hindu hard-line position to remain relevant in Punjab politics and to protect its Hindu vote-bank. Even the RSS, which had some inkling of the Bhindranwale-Khalistan issue much earlier, continued, if not increased, their morning ' shakha' (local branch) activities to reassure the Hindus of Punjab of